

HISTORY AND CULTURAL HERITAGE OF ISTANBUL

WEEK 6: Before the midterm exam...

attendance

Please follow the announcements for further information and updates.

Important Note: Please check your attendance records **through OBS**, not the HalicAPP.

The attendance records in OBS are the official records and will be taken as the basis for attendance evaluation.

- **After the midterm exams**, a new attendance system will be introduced in our classes.

- Under this new system, developed by the Distance Education Coordination Office, **attendance will be recorded during the lessons.**

- In addition to the existing **QR code** attendance system, students who join classes using mobile devices will also be able to record their attendance by entering **the code displayed below the QR code** on the shared screen into the Halic APP.

- Attendance records collected through the new system will be automatically transferred to the Student Information System (OBS).

exams

- According to our course plan, the midterm exam will count for 40% and the final exam for 60% of your final grade.
- Both exams will **be multiple-choice** and held **face-to-face** at the university.
- The exam dates will be announced once they are confirmed.
- The other sections of this course are taught by different instructors, and **each section has its own independent assessment and evaluation process.**
- Therefore, the assessment methods used in other sections do not apply to our section.
- **In our section, there will be no assignments or projects for assessment.**
- **Your final grade will be based only on the midterm and final exams.**

Our exam will be conducted face-to-face in the designated classrooms (listed in the *uzaktan eğitim** file).

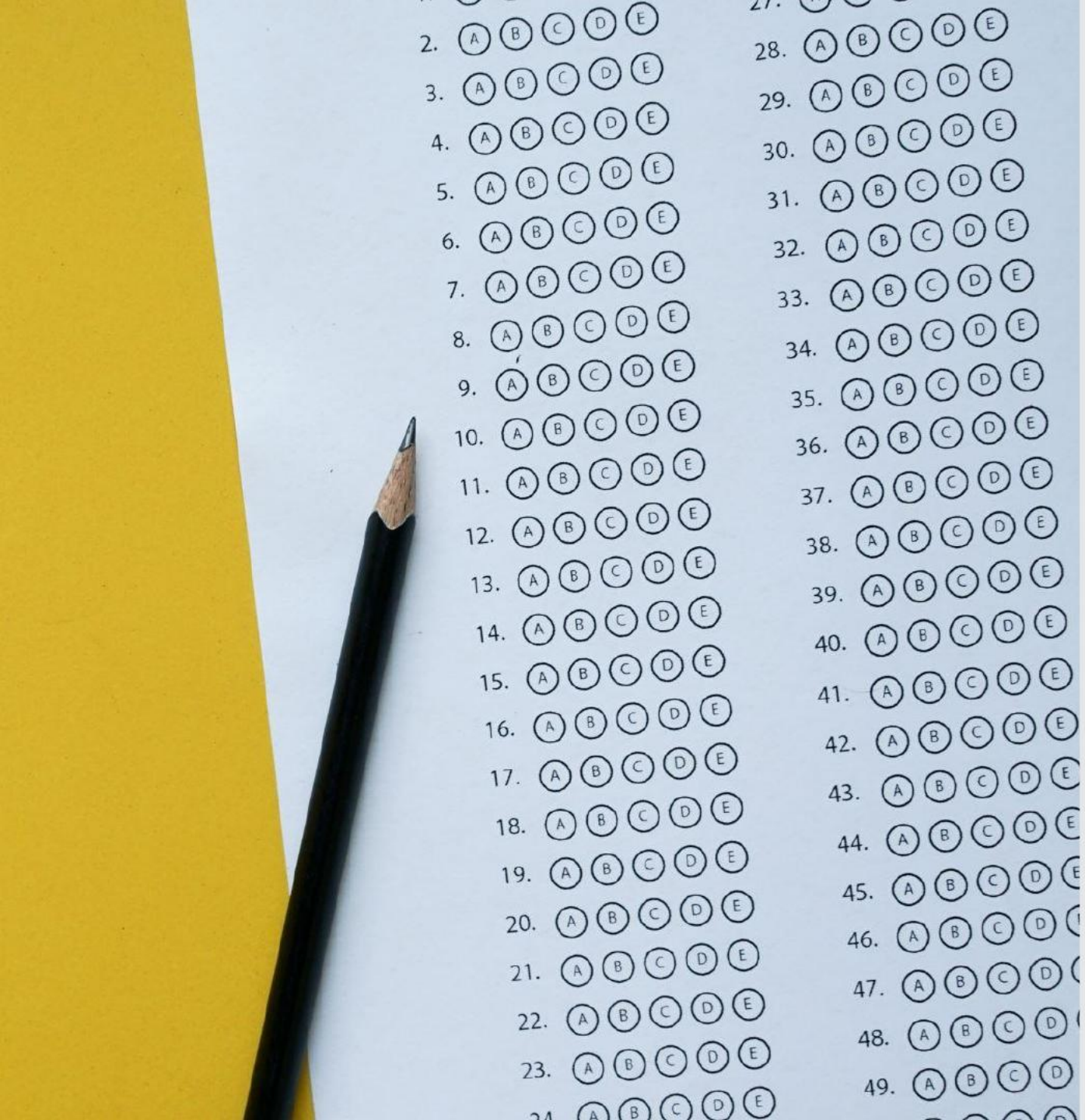
we will share a list on the Haliç-X system indicating the classroom where each student will take the exam.

Please make sure to take the exam in your assigned classroom.

You are responsible for all the topics we have covered.

All topics are included in the exam.

***Please check the list in case of any changes.** **(Probably** in the file titled «Uzaktan Eğitim».)



- In the test-based exam, there will be **25 multiple-choice questions.**
- Each student will receive a different question booklet.
- You must **mark the booklet type correctly** on the optical form.
- The exams are scored by an optical reader device, and your grade is calculated digitally.

- *The grade you receive **based on your correct answers** is final. No changes or interventions can be made. Even if your average is only one point below the passing grade, **you cannot request extra points.***

- Please note that this file **does not include a complete review of every week's topics.**
- Except for the main and important topics from the first week, the other topics are not fully covered in this file.
- Instead, the remaining topics are explained through suggestions on **how to prepare for the exam and what to focus on while studying.**
- If you study only from this file, your exam preparation will be incomplete. Therefore, you should also review the weekly lecture notes.
- A few sample exam questions are also included at the end of this file.

- Throughout the course, we have occasionally discussed political history. These topics were introduced mainly to provide background information and help you understand the historical context. **You do not need to know the political events in detail.**
- **Our main focus is the city.** We are interested in political events and historical periods that had an impact on the city and its development.
- For example, we studied the reign of Justinian and the Nika Revolt. The importance of this revolt for our course is the great damage it caused to Constantinople. After this destruction, Justinian rebuilt and restored many parts of the city. In other words, **the city was first destroyed and then rebuilt.**
- Similarly, when preparing for the exam, **you should focus on political events that directly affected the city, its architecture, urban development, and historical transformation**, rather than the political details of these events.

- Some tables and important reminders have been intentionally repeated to help you remember key information.
- The slides also contain a large number of images and visual materials. **Therefore, you should not feel overwhelmed by the number of pages.** Many slides are mainly visual and do not contain large amounts of information to memorize.

- Some topics may be repeated in different parts of the course materials.

- **Please pay attention to the main headings and categories while studying.**

- Certain topics are discussed again under different headings, sometimes in greater detail or from a different perspective.

- When studying a topic, try to understand why it is included under that particular heading and how it relates to the main subject.

- Always **pay attention to the main headings and categories, as they will help you understand the purpose and context of each topic.**

Cultural Heritage

- "Cultural heritage" is all of the concrete/material or intangible assets and facts that a society, community or mass currently preserves and created by previous generations (ancestors).

Cultural heritage:

- **1-tangible (material)** such as buildings, monuments, books, works of art or crafts
- **2-intangible** such as folklore, tradition-custom, fairy-tale-myth.
- **3-nature assets** such as natural environment, biodiversity, geological ruins

It is divided into **three main types**:

- **The tangible (material) type of Cultural Heritage is called cultural property**.

cultural assets

- **Cultural assets**; All movable and immovable assets above ground, underground or under water that are related to science, culture, religion and fine arts from prehistoric and historical periods or that have scientific and cultural unique value and were the subject of social life in prehistoric or historical periods.

- Cultural assets are divided into **movable** and **immovable**:

  Movable Cultural Assets: glass, soil, metal, stone

  Immovable Cultural Assets: monument, social complex, protected area

Sample of Movable cultural asset



Front side of a Gold coin coin



Back side of a Gold



Parfume bottle

Historical Areas of Istanbul in UNESCO World Heritage

As a result of the work carried out under the responsibility of the General Directorate of Cultural Heritage and Museums, 21 of assets from Türkiye have been included in the UNESCO World Heritage List so far. One of these assets is Historic Sites of Istanbul [1985]

Istanbul was included in the UNESCO World Heritage List in 1985 as 4 regions:

- **Sultanahmet Urban Archaeological Site**, which includes the Hippodrome, Hagia Sophia, Hagia Irene, Little Hagia Sophia Mosque and Topkapi Palace
- **Suleymaniye Conservation Area**, which includes the Suleymaniye Mosque and its surroundings
- **Zeyrek Conservation Area**, which includes Zeyrek Mosque and its surroundings
- **Istanbul Land Walls Protection Area**

The Names

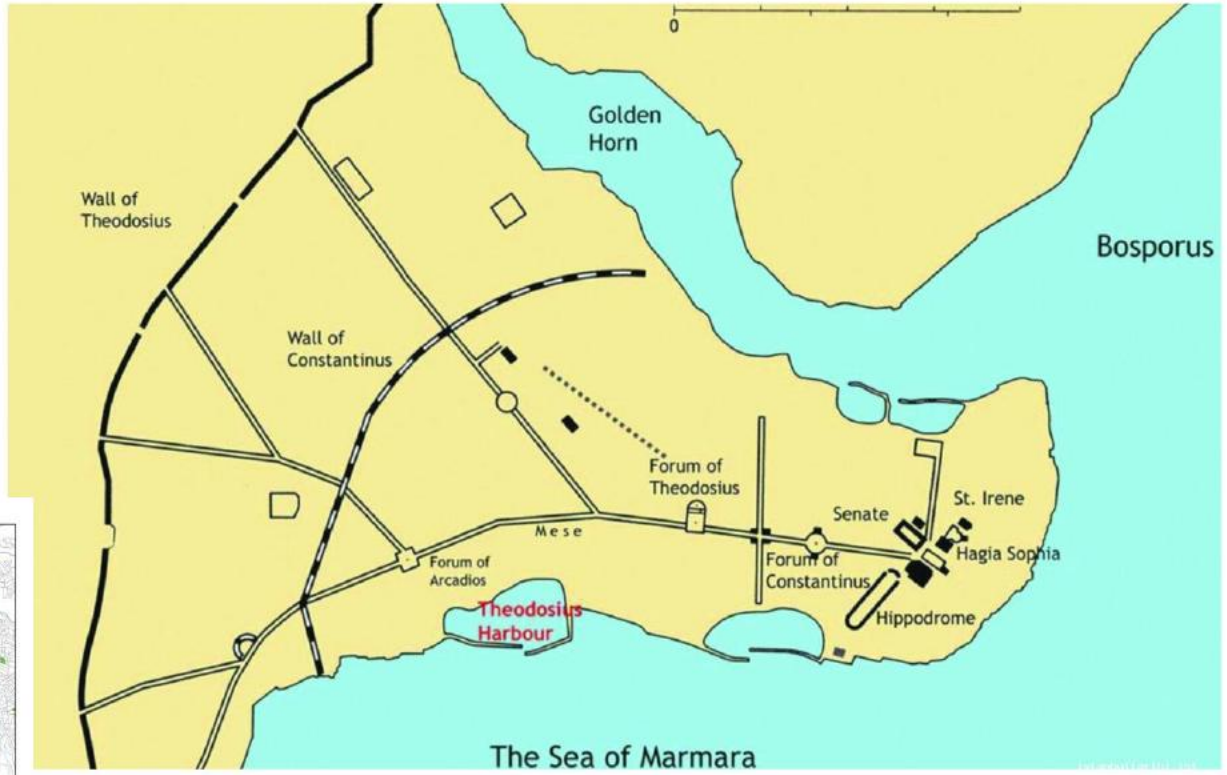
- Istanbul, which is called the "queen of cities" in the sources, has been known by different names such as **Byzantion, Augusto Antonina, Lygos, Constantinople, Konstantiniyye, Dersaadet …** throughout history.



Historical Peninsula

- The part of Istanbul surrounded by the Golden Horn in the north, the Bosphorus in the east and the Marmara Sea in the south is today known as the "Historical Peninsula".
- known as “Suriçi” (literally, inner city walls).

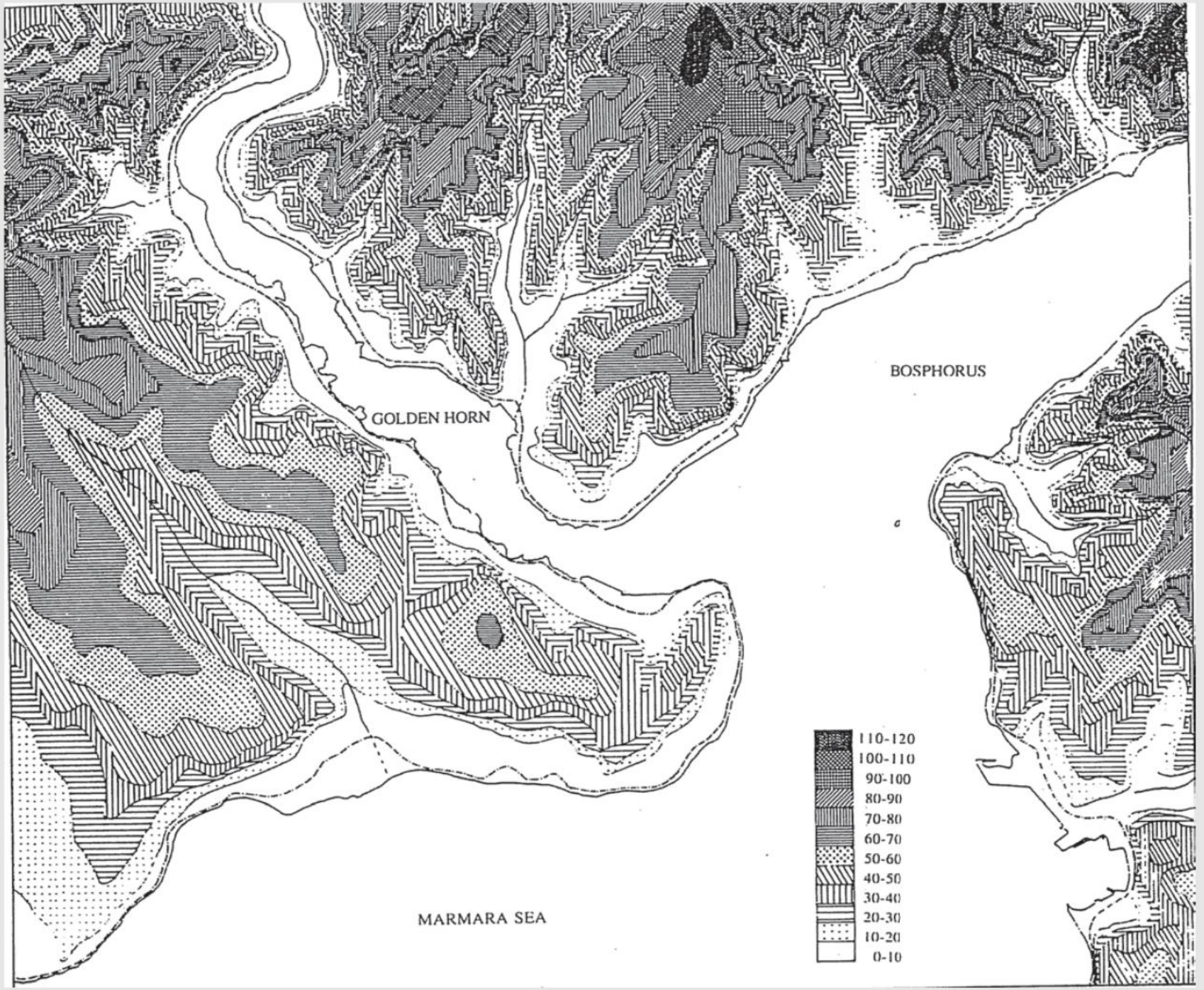


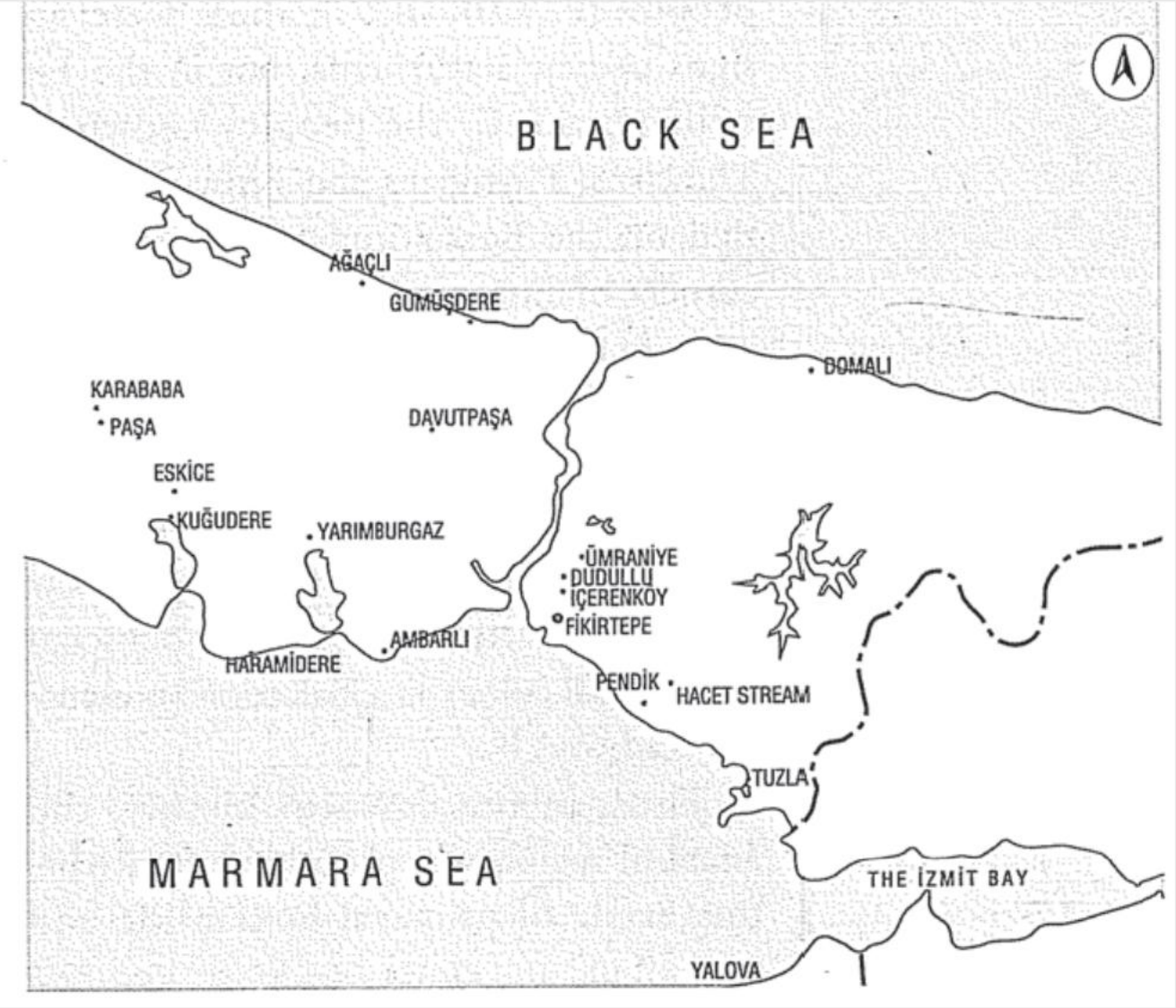


- Istanbul was founded and developed as a city on this historical peninsula. The administrative center of Byzantium and later the Ottoman Empire was also here.
- city walls:
- -land walls -sea walls

- The archaeological remains, graves and other remains which were revealed during the archaeological excavations in Yenikapı central station and other subway stations have been the first data that proved the existence of the Neolithic Period in the Historical Peninsula. Moreover, the remains of the first humans in Istanbul were detected in Yenikapı as well.
- The settlement of the Neolithic Period in Yenikapı, which is more likely sort of a fishing village, has a special importance in terms of documenting the historical background of Istanbul back to 6500 BC

- Geographical features, the civilizations that have lived in Istanbul throughout history, and the way these civilizations used physical space have shaped the topography of Istanbul.

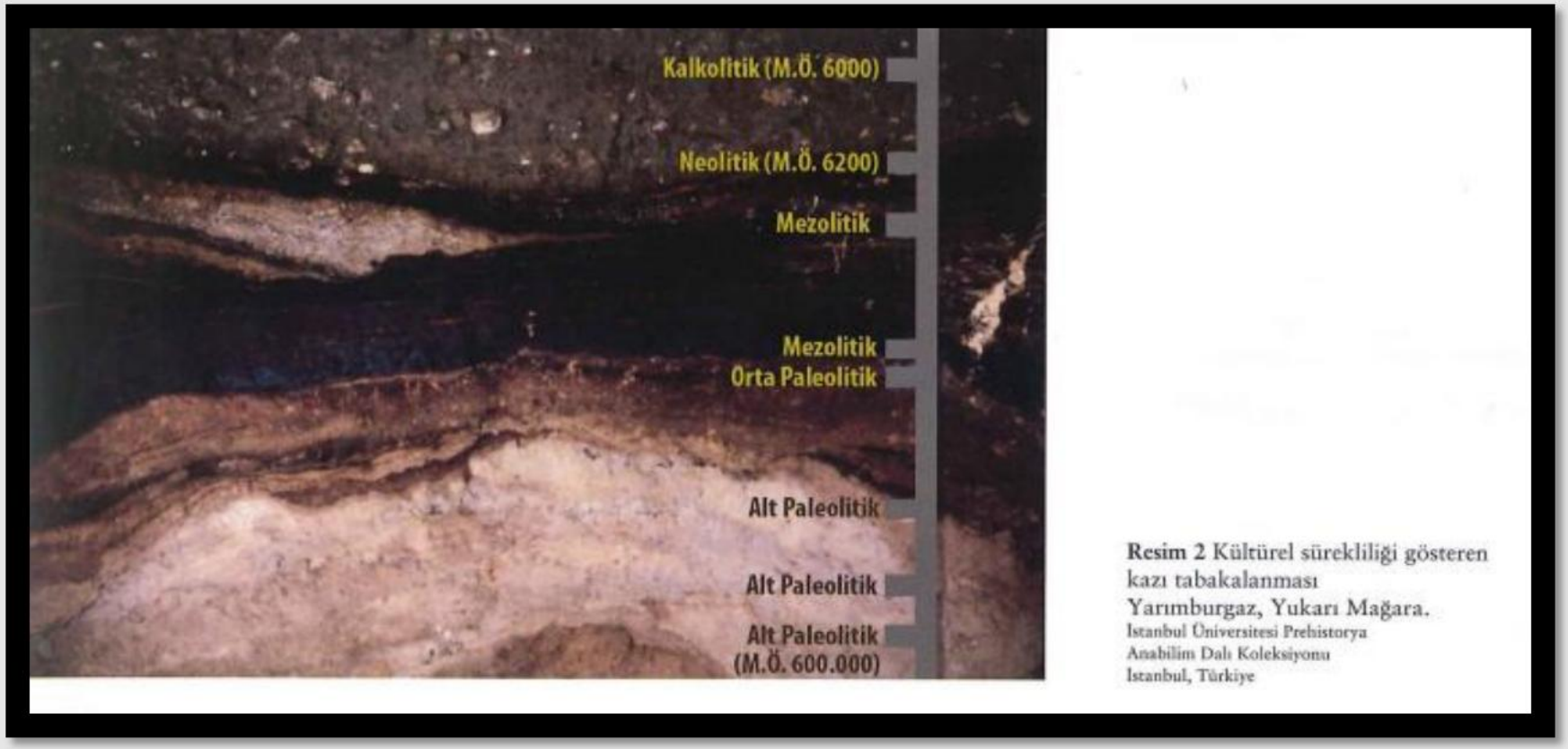




Prehistoric Settlements in Istanbul and Its Surroundings

PALEOLITHIC AGE (1 million-10,000 years ago)

- **YARIMBURGAZ CAVE near Küçük Çekmece Lake**
- **Tools used by people who make a living from fishing and hunting**



Resim 2 Kültürel sürekliliği gösteren kazı tabakalanması
Yarımburgaz, Yukarı Mağara.
İstanbul Üniversitesi Prehistorya
Anabilim Dalı Koleksiyonu
İstanbul, Türkiye

NEOLITHIC AGE (6,600-5,800 BC)

- Marmara was a narrower lake during this period. The first Neolithic settlements near the shore were established near the streams flowing into this lake and over time they were submerged under the Sea of Marmara.

- Yenikapı, FİKİRTEPE, İçerenköy, Pendik-Kaynarca, Tuzla-İçmeler

- The Neolithic Age communities of Istanbul are called the «Fikirtepe Culture».
- Partly agriculture, animal husbandry, hunting, fishing
- Pottery, tools



Resim 4 Neolitik döneme ait Fikirtepe kültüründe kemik-kaşık olarak adlandırılan aletler
Fikirtepe-Pendik
MÖ 6200-5800

CHALCOLITHIC AGE (5,800-3,200 BC)

- Cultures of Yenikapı and Yarımburgaz Cave dating to this period.
- Our information about this period is limited.

BRONZE AGE (3200-1100 BC)

- Limited information
- Ayamama Creek in Ataköy, Moda Bay

EARLY IRON AGE (1100-900 BC)

- Ataköy Ayamama Creek, Yenikapı
- During this period, a wave of migration from the Northern Balkans spread from Istanbul to Thrace.



Kat. 008 Bezekli çömlek
Yarımburgaz Mağarası,
4 Evresi buluntusu
MÖ 5600
İstanbul Arkeoloji Müzeleri
İstanbul, Türkiye

The City's Most Famous Founding Legend

- According to the tradition based on legends, Byzantion was founded by colonists from the city of Megara in Central Greece. However, it is likely that the Megarians were also joined by people from other places, especially from Kalkhedon and Miletos.
- According to the widespread view, the Megarians were founded by Byzas; the city's name also comes from Byzas.
- The mention of Byzas as the founder of the city is the product of a later historical tradition. However, the obverse of Byzantion's Roman Imperial Period coins bears the helmeted and bearded bust of Byzas and his name. According to one view, the ship depicted on the reverse of these coins is the ship that brought Byzas from Megara to Byzantion.

Date of Establishment?

- We do not have any clear information about the city's founding date.
- Herodotus (5th century BC) says that Byzantion was founded 17 years after Kalkhedon. Eusebius, who lived much later than Herodotus during the Roman Imperial Period, gives the founding date of Kalkhedon as 685 BC and Byzantion as 660/659 BC.
- Both the historian Herodotus and the geographer Strabon from Amaseia (Amasya), who lived in the 1st century BC-1st century AD, state that the first settlement on the Bosphorus was in Kalkhedon on the Anatolian side can be explained by the fact that the Kalkhedonians were blind: *If they were not blind, they would not have come and settled here when there was such a convenient place on the opposite shore.*
- As a result, it can be said that Byzantium was founded in the middle of the 7th century BC (695?-667?-660?) and after Kalkhedon.

Istanbul's old city settlement

- The present-day city of Istanbul included three ancient towns, Byzantion, Kalkhedon (Kadıköy) and Selymbria (Silivri).
- Located on both sides of the Bosphorus, Byzantion and Kalkhedon are the settlements that form the core of today's Istanbul. Selymbria was outside the city, within the borders of the Silivri district.

OTHER SMALL GREEK SETTLEMENTS (According to Dionysius of Byzantium)

- Sykai (Galata)
- Hrispolis/Khrysopolis – Scutarion (Üsküdar) (a shipyard under the Persian administration)
- Kidaros (Alibeyköy)
- Barbisos (Kağıthane)
- Selmybria (Silivri)

PERIODS OF DOMINATION IN ISTANBUL

The sieges and short-term dominance of the Dorians, Ionians, Persians (Darius I-5th century BC) and Spartans

- BC. 196: Roman as dependent city status
- 196: Septimus Severus' destruction of Byzantion
- 330-395: Roman Empire
- 395-1204 ve1261-1453: Eastern Roman (Byzantine) Empire
- 1453-1923: Ottoman Empire

Brief Chronology of BYZANTION

- 513 BC: Persian ruler Darius the Great takes control of Byzantium and Chalcedon
- 479-477 BC: Spartan commander Pausanias takes control
- Athenian rule until 411 BC
- 405-340/339 BC: Spartan rule
- 340/339 BC: Siege of Macedonian King Philip II and the Hellenistic period that lasted until the end of the century
- 3rd century BC: Dependent on the Galatian Confederation (tax) - pressure from the Bithynia and Macedonian kingdoms
- **2nd century BC: City-state affiliated with the Roman Republic after the Roman-Macedonian war**
- **73 AD: Included in the Roman Province of Bithynia-Pontus.**
- **193-196: Septimus Severus besieges Byzantium, which does not support him, destroys the city and rebuilds it**
- **324: Byzantium is completely captured by Roman Emperor Constantine I**
- **330: Becomes the capital of the Roman Empire**

Byzantium
BC.667?-
AD. 330

•Konstantinople:
330-1453

•Konstantiniyye
, Dersaadet … :
1453-1923

•İstanbul:
1923-

Advice: Prepare your own short chronology for Constantinople.

Date range: From the Roman capital in 330 to the Ottoman conquest of Istanbul in 1453.

- In 330, Byzantium became the capital of the Roman Empire.
- In 395, the Roman Empire split into two (When the last Roman Emperor Theodosius I died, the Roman Empire was divided into the Western Roman and Eastern Roman (Byzantine) Empires by his two sons)
- …..

Advice: You should also take note of the periods of important emperors.

What did he do that was important for the city?
Were there any rebellions, invasions, etc. during his time?
What were the important structures he built?
etc.

You can group the topics we have covered before according to emperors. This will make it easier for you to prepare for the exam.

For example, Constantine I

Constantine I

- He turned the city into the new capital of Rome.
- The first Roman emperor to be a Christian and to take Christianity under state protection.
- **During the Constantine period**, urban space was mainly concentrated on the eastern side of the peninsula, and the western part

- **The city and its structures during the Constantine I period**
  - city expansion (land walls were expanded)
  - the city center and surrounding buildings (acropolis, The Forum of Augusteion, Senate building, Zeuksippos baths)
    - Hippodrom and obelisks (The Egyptian obelisk-The Serpent Column and The Walled Obelisk)
    - Constantine Forum and Column of Constantine
    - Mese Street
    - Grand Palaces (The first structures that formed the core of this palace were built by Constantine)

you can improve the table..

For example, Theodosius II

- During the reign of Arcadius' son Theodosius II, the raids of the Hun Emperor Attila wore out Byzantium.

- After these raids in 447, another destructive factor was the earthquake
- **With the impact of the Hun attacks, importance was given to defense systems (construction of walls)**
- **The large part of the land walls that can still be seen today was built by Theodosios II between 412-414.**

You can prepare a similar study for Justinian or other important Roman/Byzantine emperors.

Architecture in Constantinople

The outline of changes in architecture from Rome to Byzantium

- Byzantine architecture, which was initially a continuation of the Roman Empire, has shown great differences over time, especially due to changes **in the religious field**. These differences are more **in proportions and dimensions** than in materials and workmanship.
- The monumental and propaganda-oriented structures of traditional Roman imperial architecture began to shrink with the spread of the new religion, Christianity.
- The theaters, stadiums and baths, which were indispensable elements of social life in Rome, could not find a place in the new order. When theaters were banned together with the Olympic games at the end of the 4th century, the public spaces where people could gather and have fun were restricted.
- After Christianity was accepted as the official religion at the end of the same century, baths were considered as places of evil by the clergy, and old habits were abandoned, and they began to be built on a much smaller scale and did not contain some of the features they had before.
- Another factor that changed in the new architecture was the **material size**. Brick continued to be one of the most frequently used materials. However, the large-sized bipedal bricks frequently seen in Rome were **used in smaller proportions in Byzantium**, almost half of which were used in larger proportions.

- Most of the architectural works dating back to the pre-Byzantine period have been destroyed by natural disasters and human.

- Since their parts were used as spolia, they have survived in buildings constructed in the following centuries.

- **Byzantine architecture is best seen in the field of religious architecture**. The most important reason for this is that religious buildings were in continuous use. The same is not true for the city walls that defended the city for about 1,000 years and the monuments such as water-related structures, squares, ports and obelisks that were indispensable elements of urban life.

MILITARY ARCHITECTURE

City Walls

The most important part of the city defense is the walls.

Istanbul Walls:
Land Walls
Golden Horn Sea Walls
Marmara Sea Walls



their functions, general structure, current status, who built/renovated them, etc.

CIVIL ARCHITECTURE

- Hippodrome
- Palaces
- Ports
- Water structures (Aqueduct and cistern)
- Square-obelisks

You should read your notes about these structures carefully.

For example,hippodrome..

the function of the hippodrome, its structure (its sections and the obelisks inside), who built it/expanded it by adding new structures, etc.

RELIGIOUS ARCHITECTURE (Byzantine Period)

In the period from the 11th century to the end of the 13th century, Christianity faced two important issues: the separation of the Orthodox and Catholic churches, and the Fourth Crusades.

- **church**
- **monastery**

Periods of Byzantine art and architecture

Early period (330-726): The period from the time Istanbul became the capital and the traces of traditional Roman imperial architecture were still visible in monumental structures such as Hagia Sophia.

The period of iconoclasm-depiction (726-843): The period when depictions of humans, angels and holy people, other than geometric shapes, were not included in social life and the architecture that took shape accordingly after Christianity became the official religion, and these were destroyed.

Middle period (843-1204): The period of military and financial revival when religious architecture was shaped by the church due to the dominance of the church institution despite the end of the depiction movement.

The period of the Fourth Crusade-The First Latin Kingdom (1204-1261): The period when Catholics, mostly of Venetian origin, ruled. They seized Istanbul and established a kingdom in the city instead of serving the purpose of saving the lands considered sacred to Christianity.

The last period (1261-1453): The period also known as the Palaiologan Dynasty, which left its mark on the period and began with the Byzantine administration recapturing Istanbul after fleeing to Nicaea and shifting the administrative center there during the invasion of the Fourth Crusade.

- **Hagia Sophia should be discussed in more detail!**

- **general characteristics of periods**
- **structures built in the relevant period**

for example, a church (in which period/by whom was it built, if any, its prominent feature or whether it has been damaged, its location, how it serves today, etc.)

Question examples

Which of the following is the emperor who made Istanbul the capital of the Roman Empire, "Constantinople"?

a) Constantine I (the Great)
b) Theodosius I
c) Justinianus
d) Valens
e) Mikhail Palailogos

Which of the following was the important political event in 532 that caused the third construction of Hagia Sophia?

a) The Separation of the Eastern and Roman Churches
b) The separation of the Eastern and Western Romans
c) The conquest of North Africa
d) The Nika Revolt
e) The transfer of the Patriarchate to Hagia Sophia

Which of the following is <u>not</u> one of the names Istanbul has received throughout history?

a) Nova Roma
b) Byzantion
c) Constantinople
d) Dersaadet
e) Spina

Wrong answers in the exam do not reduce the number of correct answers, try to answer all the questions!